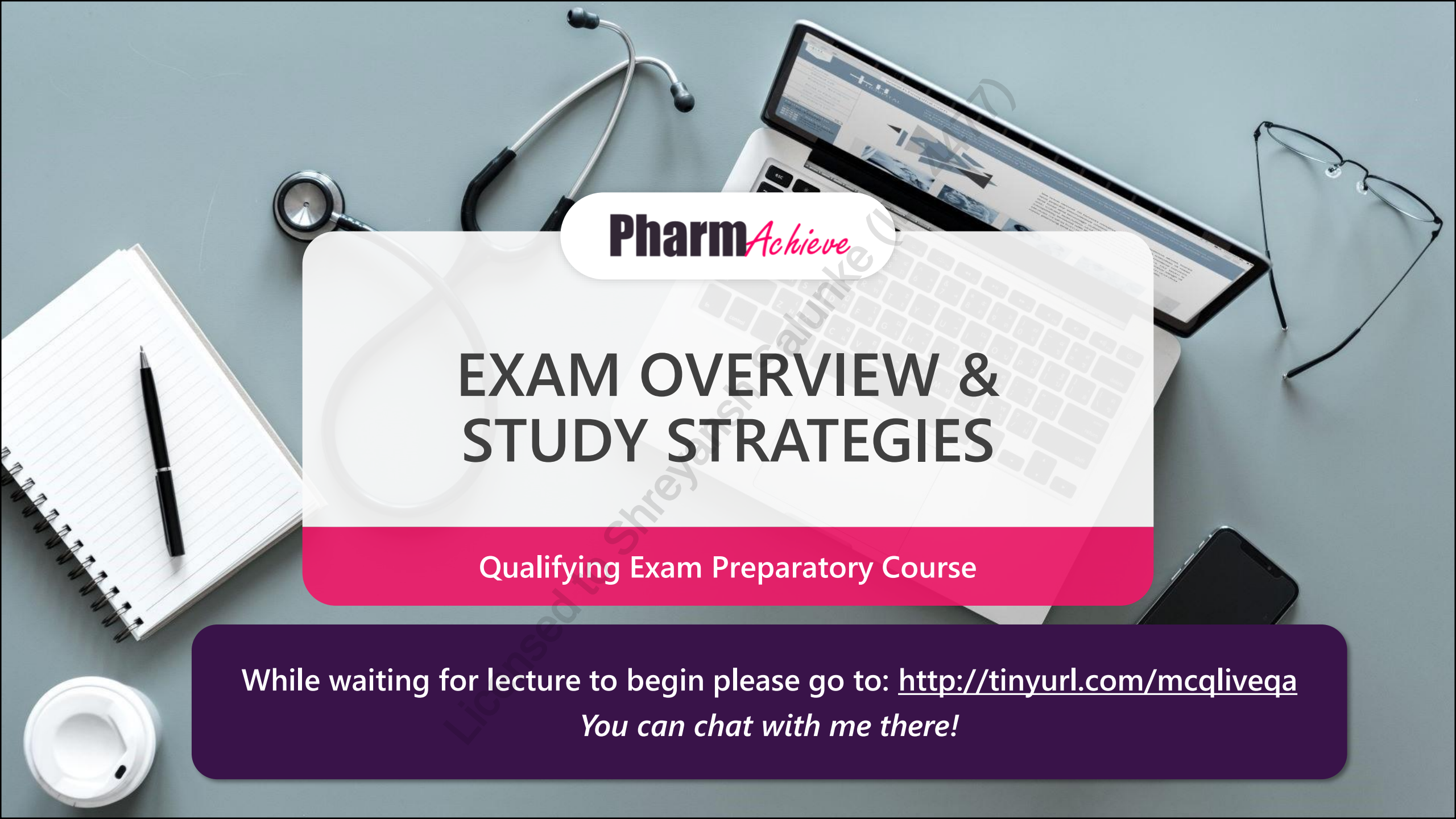




Pharm*Achieve*

EXAM OVERVIEW & STUDY STRATEGIES

Qualifying Exam Preparatory Course

While waiting for lecture to begin please go to: <http://tinyurl.com/mcqliveqa>
You can chat with me there!

PEBC CERTIFICATION



In addition to PEBC Certification → provincial requirements

MCQ EXAM OVERVIEW

Number of days	1
Method of administration	Computer Based Test
Number of questions	200
Number of questions that count towards your score	150
Point for correct question	1
Point for incorrect questions	0
Number of sections with questions	1
Pass/fail criteria	Changes every exam to make all exams equally difficult
Exam content is based on...	NAPRA Competencies for entry-level pharmacy practice

THE 6 NAPRA COMPETENCIES REQUIRED BY PHARMACISTS AT ENTRY TO PRACTICE

NEW!

Providing Care:
Clinical Care

Providing Care:
Distribution

Knowledge
& Expertise

Communication
& Collaboration

Leadership &
Stewardship

Professionalism



Overview of Topic Changes

ORGANIZATIONAL CHANGE: Consolidation of 9 competencies into 6



ADDED

Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI)

- Indigenous Experience / TRC Calls for Action
- Cultural safety/sensitivity/humility

Social Determinants Of Health

Prescribing / De-Prescribing and Adapting

Pandemic and Emergency Preparedness:
Shared Electronic Health Records

Point of Care Testing

Safety Culture



DELETED

Staff: Leadership, Support, Supervision

Organizational and Time Management



DE-EMPHASIZED

(or not explicitly tested)

Develop Master Compounding formulas



The New Blueprint Consolidates 9 Competencies into 6





MCQ Weighting Changes

2026 Domain (New)	2026 %	2014 Competency (Old)	2014 %	Change
1A. Providing Care: Clinical Care	50%	2. Patient Care	52%	-2% (Stable)
1B. Providing Care: Distribution	20%	3. Product Distribution	19%	+1% (Stable)
2. Knowledge & Expertise	11%	6. Knowledge & Research Application	6%	+5% (Significant Increase)
3. Comm. & Collaboration	4%	7. Communication (2%)+ 8. Collaboration (1%)	3%	+1% (Slight Increase)
4. Leadership & Stewardship	3%	5. Health Promotion	3%	0% (No Change)
5. Professionalism	12%	1. Ethical/Legal (7%) + 9. Quality/Safety (4%)	11%	+1% (Stable)
Redistributed	N/A	4. Practice Setting	6%	<i>Absorbed by Distribution & Professionalism</i> <i>Parts deleted</i>



Where to Find on our Website?

TOPIC

LOCATION ON PHARMACHIEVE WEBSITE

Diversity, Equity and Inclusion
Social Determinants of Health



Diversity, Equity, Inclusion (DEI): Social Determinants of Health, Health Equity, Indigenous Health, Cultural Safety & Sensitivity in the Management, Distribution, Calculations tab

Prescribing/De-Prescribing



Brand new Patient Assessment module, under the Management, Distribution, Calculations tab

Point of Care Testing



Brand-new, dedicated course displayed on dashboard when you first log in (Course Overview)

Pandemic and Emergency Preparedness



Federal Law lecture located under the Ethics, Law, Canadian System, Health Promotion tab + **NEW** Emergency Preparedness Lecture!

EHR and Documentation



Medication Reconciliation, Communication and Patient Care Process lecture

Safety Culture



UPDATED Safety and Documentation lecture

COMPETENCY 1A

50% of MCQ

Providing Care: Clinical Care

Pharmacy professionals provide safe and appropriate clinical care that meets the patient's unique needs, goals, and preferences

- Obtain relevant patient information
- Assess the patient's health status and unique needs, goals, and preferences, in partnership with the patient
- Develop a plan for the patient's care in collaboration with the patient and their circle of care
- Implement a plan for the patient's care in collaboration with the patient and their circle of care
- Monitor the patient and collaborate with the patient and their circle of care to revise the plan for the patient's care

EXAMPLES OF QUESTIONS

COMPETENCY 1A: Providing Care: Clinical Care

- When the patient asks for a recommendation regarding an over-the-counter product, what information should you collect first in order to make a clinical judgement?
- How do you choose the best first-line therapy that aligns with the patient's specific needs and preferences?
- What lab values and tests do you need to assess a patient's condition? How do you interpret the results?
- How do you create and implement a comprehensive care plan to ensure all patients' health problems are being addressed?
- *When* do you follow up with the patient? *What* do you follow up on? (Monitoring parameters)

COMPETENCY 1B

20% of MCQ

PROVIDING CARE: DISTRIBUTION

Pharmacy professionals distribute quality products and preparations that are safe and appropriate for the patient

- Review and process prescriptions
- Prepare products and preparations for dispensing
- Verify the accuracy and quality of dispensed products and preparations
- Release verified products and preparations
- Manage pharmacy inventory to ensure safe and efficient distribution

EXAMPLES OF QUESTIONS

COMPETENCY 1B – PROVIDING CARE: DISTRIBUTION

- What are the legal elements required for a prescription to be considered valid? What about a narcotic prescription?
- What does it mean when a drug is considered interchangeable with another drug?
- When should brand-name medications be dispensed?
- How do you calculate the appropriate dose of an amoxicillin suspension for a 3-year-old child?
- What are the standardized protocols for the preparation, safe handling and storage of hazardous drugs and compounded products
- What is an independent double check, and when should it be performed?

COMPETENCY 2

11% of MCQ

KNOWLEDGE AND EXPERTISE

Pharmacy professionals engage in continuous learning and improvement to provide quality care based on the best available evidence and the application of professional judgment

- Use professional judgment to make evidence-informed decisions in the best interests of the patient

EXAMPLES OF QUESTIONS

COMPETENCY 2 – KNOWLEDGE AND EXPERTISE

- A pharmacist is approached by a drug company with a new product. How can the pharmacist critically assess the product's safety and efficacy prior to recommending it?
- When changes are made to clinical practice guidelines, how can pharmacists implement them into practice?
- When a new drug comes to the market, how do you find and critically appraise relevant research and information to evaluate its safety and efficacy and overall appropriateness for the patient and their specific needs?
- How do you share and justify your evidence-informed decisions to patients and involved health care professionals?

COMPETENCY 3

4% of MCQ

COMMUNICATION AND COLLABORATION

Pharmacy professionals communicate and document effectively to enable partnership with the patient and collaboration with others to promote optimal patient care

- Use effective communication skills
- Work in partnership with the patient
- Collaborate with pharmacy colleagues, other health professionals, and other involved parties
- Document pharmacy care and services and maintain pharmacy records

EXAMPLES OF QUESTIONS

COMPETENCY 3 – COMMUNICATION AND COLLABORATION

- How do you document your clinical decisions/findings in the patient's provincial/territorial health records with precision?
- Why is it important to use active listening during patient encounters?
- How can pharmacists effectively manage conflict in practice settings?
- How can pharmacists use verbal and non-verbal communication to connect with patients who do not speak the same language?
- How can pharmacists respectfully manage disagreements between themselves and other medical professionals?
- When is it appropriate to share information with providers that are part of a patient's care team?
- How can pharmacists facilitate continuity of care? (e.g. referring the patient to other health care professionals)

COMPETENCY 4

3% of MCQ

LEADERSHIP AND STEWARDSHIP

Pharmacy professionals provide leadership, support, and supervision to pharmacy colleagues. They preserve and support community and population health in Canada

- Promote public and community health and wellness

EXAMPLES OF QUESTIONS

COMPETENCY 4 – LEADERSHIP AND STEWARDSHIP

- How can pharmacists improve patient adherence to treatment?
- Why is it important for pharmacists to assess patients' environmental, socio-economic, or other barriers to health and wellness? (Social Determinants of Health)
- How can pharmacists address vaccine hesitancy in clinical practice?
- How can pharmacists respond appropriately to emergencies (e.g. medical emergencies, environmental emergencies, robberies)?

COMPETENCY 5

12% of MCQ

PROFESSIONALISM

Pharmacy professionals comply with legal, regulatory, and ethical requirements. They commit to a culture of patient safety and promote a culturally and emotionally safe work environment for themselves and others

- Adhere to relevant legislative and regulatory requirements
- Apply ethical principles to practice
- Promote equity, diversity, and inclusion in the practice environment
- Promote a culture of patient safety and continuous quality improvement

EXAMPLES OF QUESTIONS

COMPETENCY 5 – PROFESSIONALISM

- How should you handle a situation where a parent demands to know if her daughter has been dispensed birth control?
- What ethical principle is violated if you only discuss the drug you think is best with the patient when there are multiple alternatives?
- Can a pharmacist refuse to dispense Plan B® to a patient because it goes against their religious beliefs?
- How should you manage a situation where a patient calls the pharmacy upset about a potential error made by the staff?
- How can you foster a culture where staff members feel safe reporting dispensing errors and near misses? How do you balance that with holding employees accountable for their actions?
- How do you tailor services to Indigenous patients to develop a professional connection with them and build trust?
- How do you promote diversity, equity and inclusion in the pharmacy?

READING THE CPS SHOULD BE ENOUGH, RIGHT?

Guidelines

- Based on clinical evidence
- Tips from authors are included only if they don't contradict guidelines
- Updated within weeks

CPS (RxTx)

- Common physician/ pharmacist practice
- Includes opinion of authors
- Not always frequently updated



PharmAchieve and the PEBC follow guidelines!



PEBC Resources

MYTHS AND MISCONCEPTIONS

Reading CPS and CT Minor Ailments is all I need to prepare for the MCQ exam

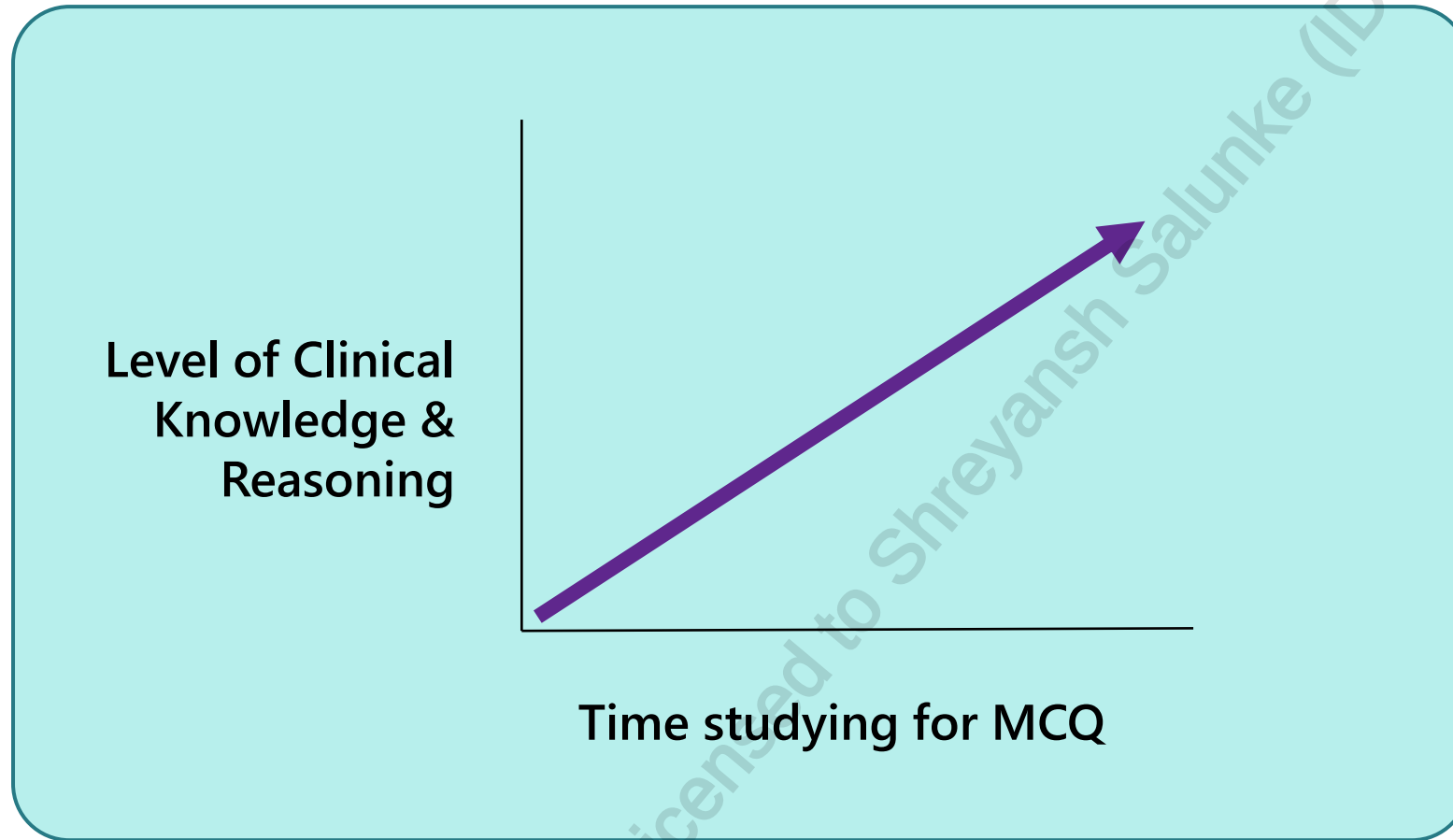
You need to pass all the competencies

Patient care, pharmacy distribution and clinical practice are NOT covered in the EE or MCQ exams

Exam difficulty varies from one exam sitting to another

Doing lengthy, complex practice cases is the best way to study for the exam

SHOULD I TAKE THE MCQ AND OSCE TOGETHER?



HOW TO STUDY



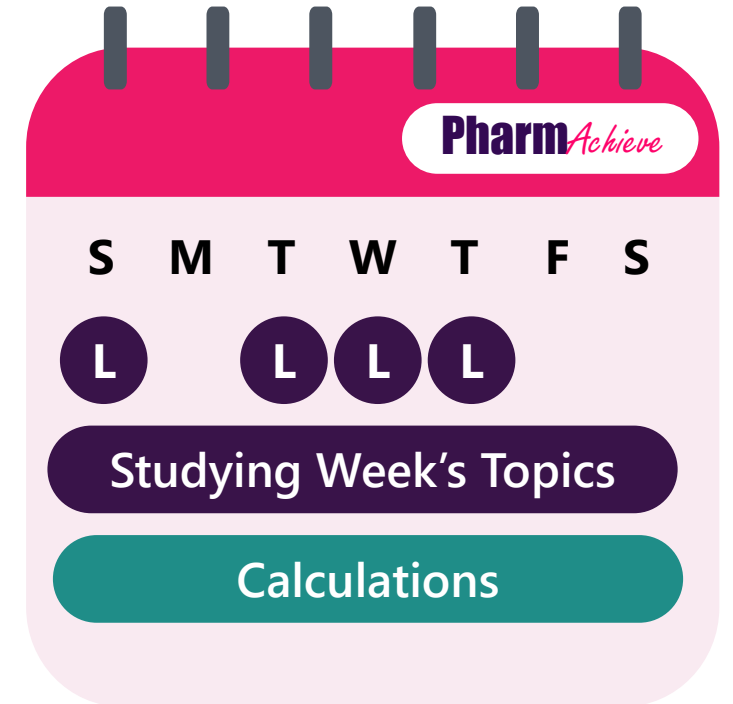
Doing quizzes of mixed topics: Reviewing mock exams with mixed topics; this forces you to frequently switch topics



Doing large quizzes: To gain exposure to as many questions as possible



Studying and testing ONE topic at a time and repeating until you achieve MASTERY!



Self-study topics are just as important as in-class lectures

HOW TO STUDY – MASTERY LEARNING

Step 1: Review ONE topic and brainstorm questions before class

Step 2: Attend live lecture, engage and ask your questions

Step 3: Complete a quiz with 10 **new** questions → Identify the weakness

Step 4: Review and re-study the specific sub-areas → Fix the weakness

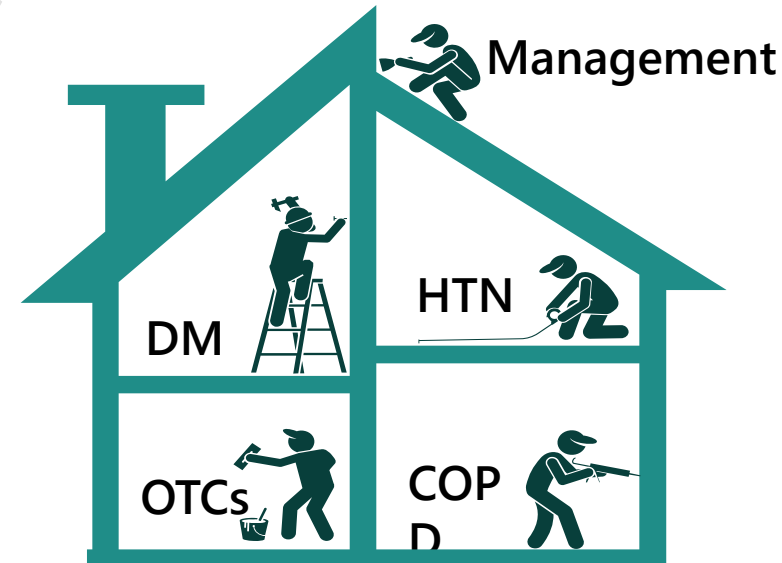
Step 5: Repeat Steps 3 and 4 until you score 100% on all quizzes

Step 6: Topic MASTERY completed! Move on to the next topic



Study and test ONE topic at a time and repeat until you achieve MASTERY!

Do **NOT** move on to the next quiz without fixing your weakness from the previous quiz!



TOP 4 REASONS PHARMACHIVE STUDENTS DON'T PASS



They only complete *a portion* of the Question Bank

- The question bank covers some materials not taught in class. Completing less than 100% of it leaves "blind spots" that may show up on the exam



They complete long quizzes or those with multiple topics

- Taking large quizzes quickly exhausts your supply of unseen questions, thus preventing the mastery learning technique of using only small (10-question), single-topic quizzes followed by remediation of weaknesses



They move on to the next quiz before fixing the weaknesses identified from the prior quiz

- You must fix your weak areas before moving on to the next topic. Otherwise, your weaknesses will remain unsolved and will follow you to the exam



They neglect DAILY Calculations practice

- You need to practice calculation questions at least 30 minutes per day (including pharmacy calculations, EBM and pharmacokinetics)

STUDY-TIPS

- Work/volunteer as a pharmacy assistant to complement your learning
- Participate in live lectures and ask and answer questions during discussions
- Create flow charts and diagrams to test your understanding
- Re-teach yourself a topic to help consolidate your knowledge
- Understand, don't memorize
 - This will help you apply concepts throughout pharmacy as body systems are linked and medications often have multiple indications
- Take breaks and do not cram
 - Studying for the PEBCs is like a long-distance marathon, not a sprint
- Aim to review concepts multiple times
- Use the PharmAchieve community to create study groups



STUDY-TIP QUESTIONS

**ARE SELF-STUDY TOPICS JUST AS
IMPORTANT AS IN-CLASS LECTURES?**

STUDY-TIP QUESTIONS

**ARE CLINICAL TOPICS MORE IMPORTANT
THAN NON-CLINICAL TOPICS?**

STUDY-TIP QUESTIONS

**DO I NEED TO USE RESOURCES OUTSIDE
OF PHARMACHIEVE TO STUDY?**

A top-down view of a desk with various items: a laptop with a website on the screen, a stethoscope, a spiral notebook with a pen, a pair of glasses, a smartphone, and a white coffee cup. A large, semi-transparent white rectangle with a red border is centered over the laptop, containing the text "ANY QUESTIONS?".

ANY QUESTIONS?